

YUKA

Phase 3: PRODUCT REQUIREMENT DOCUMENT

Why? (Objective)

User :

Health conscious/General wellness focused users are finding YUKA scores are misleading as some products that they know that are 'healthy' for them are poorly scored and vice versa. This lack of contextual scoring leads to confusion and reduces trust in the app for the user

For Business:

This is a complex problem to solve as multiple factors such as concentration, real nutritional value of a product beyond nutriscores, user's health goals have to be considered to give accurate scores that are relevant for them. Users don't go for conversion as they are not happy with 'basic' scoring and use the app only for 'additives' checking, this affects revenue as it reduces conversion. If this is not addressed, it could gradually affect retention in future.

Who are the users ?

Health conscious, wellness focused users who are on free tier

Persona :

Susan Paul

Healthy eating and clean personal care products – focused individual, working as Occupational Therapist . A mother who uses the product regularly during weekend grocery shopping. Free tier user, for past 6 months

Needs :

- Interested in scanning food products to ensure if they are free of additives, healthy, not highly processed
- Have YUKA provide accurate scores that she can rely on for her, family's healthy eating habits
- Use YUKA to avoid cosmetics, kids personal care products such as soaps, suncreams that includes chemicals or toxins

Problems we are solving :

Scoring feels misleading. Users feel the scoring is not accurate in some cases and does not consider their individual health preferences such as ultra processing levels, micro plastics, allergens , portion size etc . This results in scores that users find unacceptable ie some healthy products can be scored low and vice versa. Because of this they limit the app to only scan for additive, than a tool that gives them confidence in making overall healthy choice

Frustrations expressed :

- "I don't understand why some healthy products are scored so low just because it has bit of salt."

- "I cant find how much ultra processing has gone into making of it. I would be interested in microplastics in food .I don't know if ranking takes all of that into account"
- Sometimes scores don't look right and additional checking of all ingredients is required

Qualitative voice of user from interview : "Sometimes the scores are off ,so I manually check the ingredients details, but only for additives .I know I am fine with slightly high calories or fats "

Survey Responses :

More than 80% of respondents have selected they personally didn't choose to buy a product rated by YUKA as good/excellent as the product didn't suit their health needs or contained ingredients they didn't want and 33.9% of those felt they couldn't explain it, but it didn't feel right. Though YUKA never intended to score ultra processed foods as excellent, that's how people perceive it and are actively mislead ,and they either do their own research and ignore the scores or lose confidence in the app, stop using it.

Solution

Indicate 'Food Processing' level as it's a key factor that most users are concerned about when deciding if a product is healthy and provide clarification on scoring using AI so that users can easily understand the rationale behind scoring than feeling annoyed as to why certain scores are inaccurate

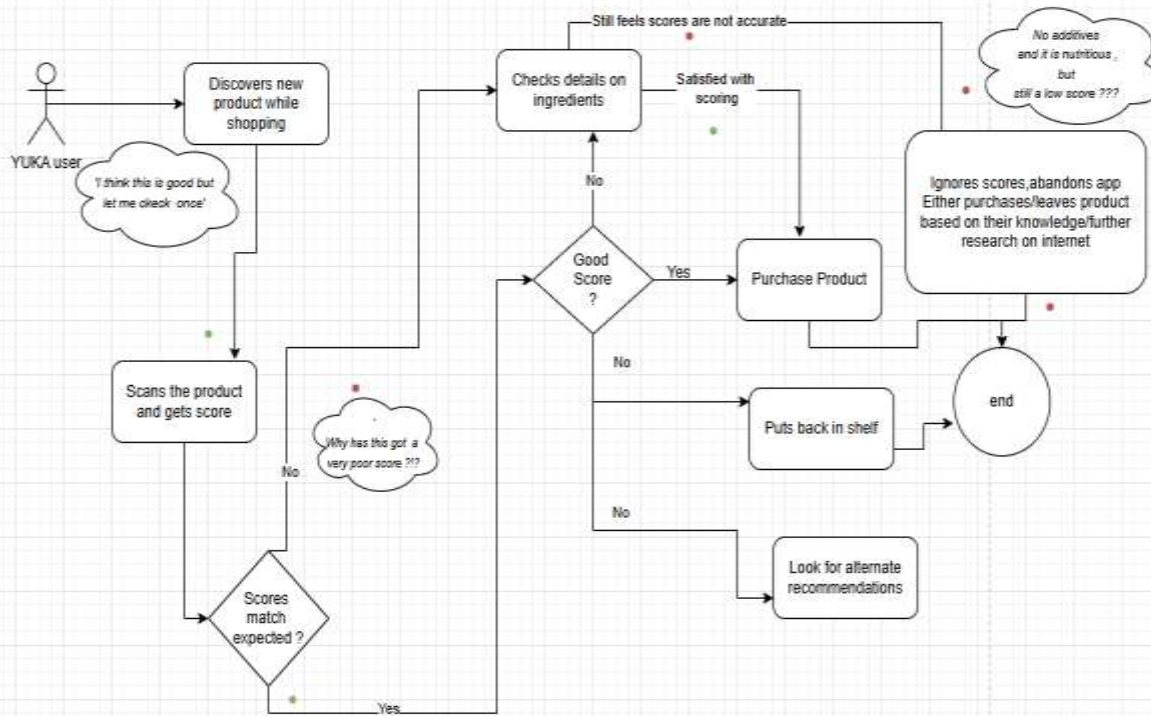
Other Alternatives considered :

SOLUTION	REACH	IMPACT	CONF	EFFORT	RICE SCORE	NOTES
Indicate Food Processing level	3	3	3	2	13.5	Reaches all users, higher confidence based on qualitative user feedback
Customization for individual needs	2	3	3	2	9	easy to build based on existing platform features, strong evidence for the need from platform analysis and user surveys but could be offered only for members

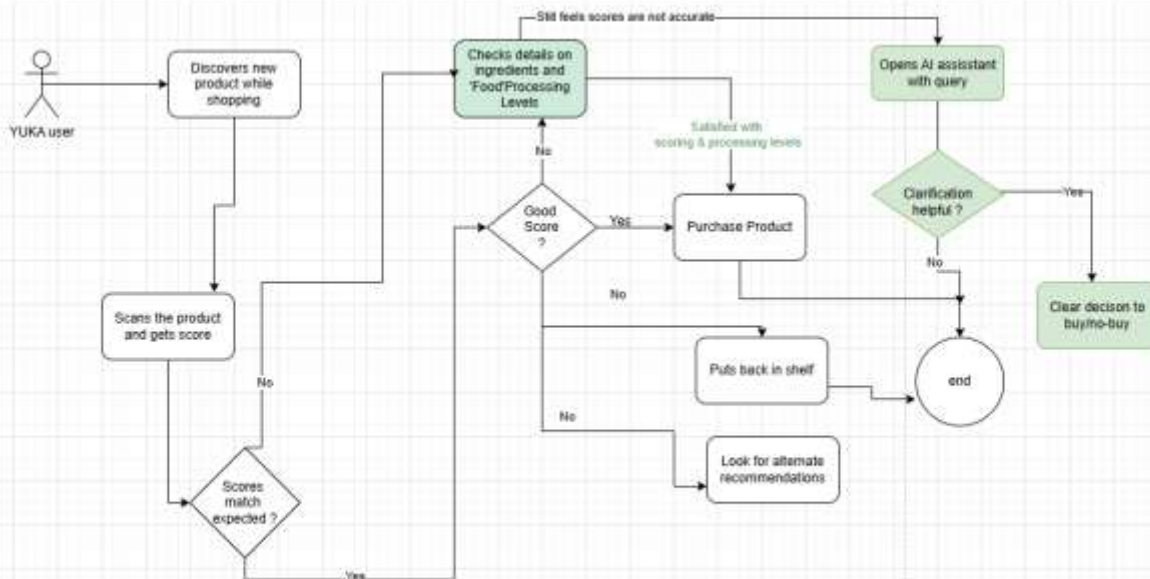
Access Health Metrics from connected devices/applications	1	3	2	3	2	Moonshot feature which relies on integrating with phone's health ecosystem and targeted towards niche audience
Over Simplificaiton of scoring	2	3	2	3	4	Changes core scoring capability and could be idea for future
Provide Clarification on scoring	3	2	3	2	9	Reduces user friction in understanding scores ,resulting in better clarity and relatively easier to implement
Present hazards associated with ingredients	3	1	2	1	6	Low impact and can make some users overwhelmed with more detailed health hazard information

Product Flow

Flow Diagram (Current Status)



Flow Diagram (Future)



Prototype

<https://ai.studio/apps/59949c46-84d6-479c-bcdc-9c97b44b3b96>

High Level Features :

1.As a user

When I come across packaged food products

I want 'Food processing' levels displayed

So that I can better decide if the product is healthy or not based on processing levels

2.As a user

When I see scores different to my expectations

I want detailed clarification

So that I can understand the rationale behind scoring and make an informed decision

Tentative Timelines

TASK	DATE
Leadership Approval	
Design ready	
Prototype Testing	3
Development starts	

How do we measure success?

METRIC TYPE	METRIC NAME	DEFINITION	WHY IT MATTERS
KEY METRIC	Quarterly Rate of retention	No decrease in no of existing free tier users (quarterly/monthly monitor for 4 quarters) → after the 'food processing levels' and AI scoring are implemented	It measures if existing users are using the product consistently and if it increases after the 'food processing' levels, AI scoring is implemented
GUARDRAIL	Rate of engagement	% of existing users not scanning as much as before after viewing ingredient details pane or engaging with AI assistant	Shows that these features have mislead them and have not been useful, so they disengage
METRIC	App Store Rating Improvement	Increase in average Apple app store and Google Play store rating after launch of the 'food processing levels' and AI scoring feature (tracked monthly/quarterly)	Measures overall user satisfaction and perceived feature value. Higher ratings improve app credibility, discoverability, and more user adoption
GUARDRAIL	Negative Review Rate	% of new App Store and Google Play reviews mentioning confusion, inaccurate scoring, or dissatisfaction with AI-generated insights	Helps identify whether the new features are creating frustration, mistrust, or usability issues that could harm adoption and retention
Supporting Metric	Increase in Review Volume	Increase in the number of user reviews submitted after feature rollout	Indicates stronger user engagement and higher user willingness to provide feedback.
Supporting Metric	AI Feature Satisfaction Rate	% of users providing positive feedback (thumbs up, helpful rating, or positive sentiment) after interacting with AI agent on rationale for food score	Measures whether users find the AI-powered insights valuable and understandable, and that they can trust it.

Measuring Quarterly Rate of retention

No decrease in no of existing free tier users (quarterly/monthly monitor for 4 quarters)

Assumption Q1 2026 Baseline number of users (existing and already using the app) – 70 M

Quarter	Baseline	New Users
Q1 2026	70 M	5 M
Q2 2026	Target – To Retain 70M. New Baseline – 75M	2 M
Q3 2026	Target – To Retain 75M. New Baseline – 77M	1 M
Q4 2026	Target – To Retain 77M. New Baseline – 78M	4 M

Risks and Mitigation

ASSUMPTION AT RISK	FAILURE MODE	IMPACT	LIKELIHOOD	MITIGATION	DETECTION SIGNAL	CONTAINMENT
Users will view the 'food processing' levels slider	Users don't scroll for ingredients details to check food processing levels	HIGH	MEDIUM	Targeted survey of Beta users to check if they saw the food processing details on ingredients view	Survey response indicating users not visibly noticing the processing levels	Visual indication of processing levels along with scores; Alert users about this new feature for first 3 months
Users want to view food processing slider by default	Users are overwhelmed with additional details	HIGH	LOW-MED	Make this a simpler dropdown pane that is not displayed by default and shown only if they click	Low click rates of ingredient details pane as they are confused due to more details displayed	Come up with simpler visual icons to indicate processing levels
Users will find AI assistant extremely helpful to understand product scores	They are annoyed by AI chat assistant's responses and don't prefer to share their questions	HIGH	MED	Make AI chat more intuitive than providing generic responses which users can see themselves on screen	Less adoption of AI assistant and low engagement rate once AI chat is initiated	Offer additional email support (responded by YUKA team) for unsatisfied users

	with an AI agent					
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Dependencies

- 1. Open Questions
- 2. Infrastructure requirements -
- 3. Budget Approvals -N/A
- 4. Partner Support- N/A
- 5. Internal Dependencies